

recovery. He was taken on a stretcher to the North Riding Infirmary, where he was for some time partly unconscious, and died at eleven o'clock at night. Among other visitors who received injuries were M. Simon, inventor of the Simon-Carves coking process; Mr. Leonard Cooper, of Leeds; Mr. James Whetham, of Leeds, and Major Stevenson, of Middlesbrough. Several workmen were also badly injured. One of them, E. Ramsden, is not expected to survive. Upon being made acquainted with the accident, the institute adjourned its sittings for the day.

The four steam-torpedo boats for harbour and river defence ordered by the New Zealand Government from Messrs. Thornycroft, of Chiswick, were tried on Wednesday in the presence of a number of visitors interested in the colonies at the measured mile at Purfleet. The highest speed attained was 639 revolutions per minute, and a speed of 17.524 knots, by No. 168, and the lowest, 628 revolutions and a speed of 17.222 knots, by No. 169. The boats are intended for the discharge of spar torpedoes at a distance of about 30 feet from their bows and Whitehead torpedoes from their sides, and they can strike a vessel with a deadly effect at about nine feet below the surface of the water. After the trials luncheon was served in the Nelson-room at the Trafalgar Hotel, Greenwich. Sir Francis Bell presided, who said when the insurrection broke out twenty years ago aid had to be obtained from Sydney, and he well remembered what an anxious time it was. With these armoured vessels the colonists would be prepared to do their duty as part of the British Empire, protect their coasts, and maintain peace inland.

The sheriffs of London state that upwards of 1,200 applications have already been received for the post of executioner, vacated by the death of Marwood. These have been sent from the Home Office and elsewhere to the sheriffs of London and Middlesex, who are now engaged in so considering and sifting them as to have a fitting man at hand to carry out the sentence of the law in case of need. The sheriffs wish it to be particularly known that to reply to so large a number of applications is impracticable, but that original testimonials, where such have been sent, will in all cases be returned in due course.

The weekly return of metropolitan pauperism shows that the total number of paupers at the end of the first week in September was 85,035, of whom 50,207 were in workhouses and 34,828 received out-door relief. Compared with the corresponding week of last year this was a decrease of 2,399, but compared with 1880 there was an increase of 2,893. In the corresponding week of 1881 the numbers were precisely the same as in 1883. The number of vagrants relieved on the last day of the week was 419, of whom 292 were men, 99 women, and 28 children under 16.

The receipts on account of revenue from the 1st of April, 1883, were £36,039,165, against £35,233,433 in the corresponding period of the preceding financial year. The net expenditure was £37,530,192, against £38,650,396 to the same date in the previous year. The Treasury balances on Sept. 15 amounted to £4,717,720.

There were 2,488 births and 1,260 deaths registered in London last week. The births were 97 and the deaths 121 below the average numbers. The annual rate of mortality from all causes, which had been equal to 17.0 and 16.6 per 1,000 in the two preceding weeks, was last week again 16.6. The deaths included 1 from small-pox, 24 from measles, 48 from scarlet fever, 21 from diphtheria, 30 from whooping-cough, 31 from enteric fever, 62 from diarrhoea and dysentery, 1 from simple cholera, and not one from typhus. The deaths referred to diseases of the respiratory organs, which had been 148 and 150 in the two preceding weeks, were 157 last week, and were 26 below the corrected weekly average. In Greater London 3,154 births and 1,573 deaths were registered, equal to annual rates of 33.0 and 16.4 per 1,000 of the population. The mean temperature of the air was 57.8 deg., and .01 deg. below the average in the corresponding week of the twenty years ending 1868.

OBITUARY.

Lady Morshead, sister of Sir William Harcourt and Mr. Edward W. Vernon Harcourt, M.P., died on Friday at Forest Lodge, Binfield, Berks. She was born in 1833, and married in 1854 Sir Warwick Charles Morshead, Bart.

Sir William Taylor Thomson, K.C.M.G., C.B., died at Caerler, Innerleithen, on Saturday. Sir William was Chargé d'Affaires and Consul-General in Chili from 1858 to 1872, and was then appointed Envoy Extraordinary and Minister Plenipotentiary for Persia, an office which he held for seven years.

We regret to announce the death of Miss Orridge, a young and popular contralto vocalist. Towards the middle of last month Miss Orridge joined her family at Guernsey for a short holiday, but two days afterwards she was seized with an illness which terminated fatally last Sunday. Miss Orridge was born in London in 1856, and was a pupil of Senor Manuel Garcia, at the Royal Academy of Music, carrying off the bronze medal in 1876, the silver medal and Llewellyn Thomas gold medal for declamatory singing in 1877, and the certificate of merit, the Parepa Rosa gold medal, and the Christine Nilsson prize in 1878. She has since then enjoyed a high position as an oratorio and concert singer.

The death is announced of Mr. John Payne Collier, the Shakspearian commentator, at the advanced age of ninety-four. He was in his younger days law and parliamentary reporter to the *Morning Chronicle*, then under the editorship of Mr. Perry, and afterwards became well known by his critical essays upon the Elizabethan poets and dramatists. He subsequently became librarian to Lord Ellesmere, and it was among the manuscripts in his lordship's library that he discovered the greater part of the documents of which he made use in his "New Facts regarding the Life of Shakspeare," published in 1836, and in subsequent works. Mr. Collier will also be remembered as having taken an active part in the controversy respecting the antiquity and authority of the MS. marginal notes in a copy of the folio edition of Shakspeare. He was connected with several learned and antiquarian societies, and had for many years been in receipt of a pension of £100 a year in recognition of his services to literature.

THE CHURCH AND THE UNIVERSITIES.

There has been no appreciable change in the condition of the Bishop of Peterborough during the past week. His lordship continues to get up for a few hours daily.

The Bishop of Bangor has consecrated a new church at Capel Curig, which has been erected almost at the sole cost of Lord Penrhyn.

The Duke of Devonshire, the sole surviving trustee, has appointed the Rev. G. Herbert Curtis, Canon of Lichfield, and Professor of New Testament Exegesis at King's College, to be Boyle Lecturer for 1884-87.

LAW AND POLICE. CRIME IN LONDON.

A CONFERENCE OF LONDON DETECTIVES.

A two days' conference of detective-inspectors, under the presidency of the Director of the Criminal Investigation Department, has just been held, it is reported, at Scotland-yard. The subjects discussed were the best means of preventing and detecting crime in the metropolis, and it is stated that a large amount of useful information as to the antecedents, habits, and proceedings of well-known criminals, as well as suspected persons, was elicited, and many very valuable suggestions for dealing with them were made by a number of the most active and intelligent members of the force. The increasing crime of burglary occupied the attention of the conference for some time, the recent attacks upon the police by armed burglars giving the subject a particularly personal interest. It is reported that during the past five or six weeks scarcely a night passes without from five to eight burglaries being reported, and the use of the revolver is said to be largely on the increase. In securing Thomas Webb, in custody for the burglary at Wimbledon, the police believe that they have made a most important capture. Mr. Howard Vincent is reported to have expressed himself well satisfied with the results of the conference, and it is further stated that in the light of recent events there will be a better reorganization and still greater energy instilled into the force.

THE ARMING OF NIGHT PATROLS.

Printed forms have been issued to all the sergeants and constables in the outlying districts, with the object of obtaining definitely their opinion on the question of arming constables on night duty with revolvers. It is said that when these forms are returned it will probably be found that the constables are almost unanimously in favour of revolvers being carried for night patrol. The sergeants, like the inspectors, as a body, are, on the other hand, opposed to the arming of the constables. Double patrols necessitate a considerable increase in the number of constables for night duty, and many of the men, it is stated, say that when in company with a brother officer they cannot help falling into conversation, and consequently are not so alive to sounds as when alone. If armed with a revolver they think there would be very little chance of an encounter occasion to use it, as burglars would not run the risk of an encounter with them. It is fully anticipated in some quarters that as soon as all the reports of the constables have been analyzed at headquarters a number of revolvers will be issued to each suburban station for distribution among the night duty men. They will only be in the possession of the men when on night duty.

THE WALTHAMSTOW MURDERS.

William Gouldstone (twenty-six), blacksmith, was placed at the bar of the Central Criminal Court to take his trial for the murder of his five children. Mr. Poland and Mr. Montagu Williams prosecuted on behalf of the Public Prosecutor; Mr. Grain and Mr. G. Elliott defended the prisoner. Mr. Poland opened the case for the prosecution. The learned counsel gave a brief outline of the facts of the case, which are well known. He said the prisoner, who was by trade a blacksmith, was represented as being a sober, hardworking man, and very fond of his children. The only motive that appeared to be suggested for the commission of the crimes was that the prisoner was under the impression that he should not be able to support his family, especially after his wife had been confined with twins, which had evidently preyed upon his mind. After they had heard the evidence, Mr. Poland added, he believed that the only question that would remain for the consideration of the jury was whether the prisoner was insane at the time he committed the terrible deed. Mr. Grain, for the prisoner, said that the facts could not be disputed, and the only defence that could be made was that at the time the horrible deeds were committed the prisoner was insane, and not criminally responsible. Witnesses were then examined, who proved that several members of the prisoner's family were insane, and that one or two of them had died in a lunatic asylum. One or two other relations of the prisoner, it appeared, had also attempted to commit suicide. The father of the prisoner stated that he had several other sons, but the prisoner was the only one of his children who did not seem to be right in his mind. Some fellow-workmen of the prisoner's proved that some time before the murder it was noticed that his conduct was very strange. He complained of severe pains in his head. On several occasions he threatened to commit suicide, and he had asked some of his fellow-workmen to knock his brains out with a hammer. Dr. Savage, one of the medical officers of Bethlehem Hospital, said he had examined the prisoner, and upon all the facts he was of opinion that the man was insane when he committed the murders. The jury eventually found the prisoner guilty of wilful murder, and sentence of death was passed in the usual manner. Gouldstone was afterwards taken to Chelmsford Prison. Mr. J. Oxley Parker, the High Sheriff of Essex, has, it is stated, received numerous applications from persons desirous of acting as hangman, but up to the present no definite arrangements have been made.

EXTRAORDINARY CAREER OF A CURATE.

The Aston police on Monday succeeded in effecting the arrest at Erdington of the Rev. Thomas Morris Hughes, a Church of England clergyman, for whose apprehension, on a charge of bigamy, a warrant was issued by the Birmingham magistrates about a month ago. The prisoner, who was acting up to July last as curate-in-charge of the parish of Bickenhill, near Birmingham, is said to be well-known to the police, having been convicted on various occasions of drunken and riotous conduct and grave offences, notably on the 23rd of July, 1875, when he was sentenced by Lord Coleridge at Beaumaris to five years' penal servitude for having, by a false representation, obtained a certificate for the burial of his step-daughter's child, of which he was believed to be the father. Hughes was liberated from prison before the expiration of his full sentence, in 1879, when he took up his abode with his wife in Birmingham, reporting himself to the police from time to time as required by the rules. In 1881 he left his wife, and obtained employment as chaplain at some works near Bromsgrove. He afterwards became curate of Wellesbourne, where he made the acquaintance of a young woman of humble parentage, whom he wooed as a single man, and married on the 8th of February, 1881. In October, 1882, he relieved the vicar of Bickenhill during a lengthened absence in the charge of that parish, where he appears to have made himself very popular by his eloquence in the pulpit and his sociable manners. On the return of the vicar, the Rev. Rawlins Capel, in April last, some unpleasant rumours with regard to the curate began to circulate, and when Mr. Capel pressed him for explanations, Hughes suddenly disappeared, and with him the vicar's cook, with whom he had evidently been carrying on a guilty intrigue. Hughes's second wife had just given birth

to a child, and the elopement of her second wife, Hughes was by police-court on inquiries have he eloped from London to drink, with them they saw hended him. It by taking poison depended for his

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